

Patrizia Noel Aziz Hanna – Barbara Sonnenhauser

Introduction: Approaching a syntax of pragmatics

1. The syntax of pragmatics

Syntax serves pragmatic functions by encoding indexical relations to the immediate context of communication, i.e. the situational, textual, and interlocutive context. The key indexical processes involved in a syntax of pragmatics can be subsumed under the concepts of a) addressing interlocutors, b) adding information, and c) signalling (inter-)textual references. These processes are exemplified in *The syntax of pragmatics: Addressing, adding, signalling* by vocatives, parentheticals, and quotations.

Traditionally, and also depending to a large degree on the specific language in question, vocatives, parentheticals, and quotations are classified either in formal terms as part of the language system (e.g. as the a priori categorised classes of vocative case, parenthetical adverbs, or quotative particles), or as functional structures manifesting themselves in language use only. This constitutes a typical dilemma encountered for ‘indexical symbols’ as elements of language for which a “general meaning [...] cannot be defined without reference to the message” (JAKOBSON 1971[1958]: 131). Indexical phenomena encode context-dependency, which makes them conventionalised/predictable and ad hoc/unexpected at the same time. The indexical relation is not conventionalised in the sense of being obligatorily signalled by morphosyntactically and prosodically coded markers of syntagmatic cohesion but tied to an intentional deviation from syntagmatic expectations. The intentional employment of unexpected structures of usage needs to be recognised by the interlocutors on the basis of their knowledge about conventionalised linguistic structures. Their signalling and recognition are essential within this context, because indexical functions are not mandatorily coded by form-function pairs.

Even though vocatives, parentheticals and quotations are highly frequent patterns, they are marginal in grammatical descriptions. What is more, they

are usually treated as isolated phenomena, sometimes even as deviant occurrences or ‘suboptimal structures’ (cf. STERNEFELD et al. 1999-2008). The contributions gathered in this issue take a different perspective in regarding these structures of language usage as being highly relevant for adequately approaching the grammar of a language, since they exhibit very regular patterns. These patterns can be observed if the structures in question are described as being located on a ‘secondary’, ‘supplementary’, or ‘additional’ layer of syntax, from which they interact with ‘primary’ or ‘basic’ syntax.¹ The concept of a ‘syntax of pragmatics’, as proposed here, allows a focus on the function and structural regularities of this phenomenon. It permits to highlight the fact that not only particular lexical items (e.g. personal pronouns) or grammatical categories (e.g. tense) but also syntactic structures may be indexical. Indexicality is understood in semiotic terms, which defines ‘index’ as a “reactional sign, which is such by virtue of a real connection with its object” (EP 2: 163). Indices are context-dependent and serve attentional control. As phenomena of ‘existence’ (cf. EP 2: 277) they need not be conventionalised and typically emerge only in the actual context of usage. Indexicality underlies the ability of the aforementioned structures to encode a relation to their immediate context of communication; at the same time, these structures specify the nature of this communicative embedding.

Structures of secondary syntax are, in a way, ‘outside’ the predictable syntactic structure, which makes them unexpected. It is exactly this ‘outsider’ position from which they derive their function. The relationship between ‘basic’ and ‘secondary’ syntax provides the pragmatic, i.e. indexical, potential of the structures in question. The indexical relation establishes a meaningful connection to the contextual embedding – both situational and textual – of an utterance. Thus clearly, within a syntax of pragmatics the structures in question cannot be considered ‘secondary’ in terms of function; the term ‘secondary’ rather takes into account the additional information provided by these structures by way of abduction, i.e. the reasoning process by which an explanatory hypothesis is created (EP 2: 216). In activating the creation of an explanatory hypothesis such structures differ from ‘performance errors’. What makes the description of the indexical relationship between primary and secondary syntax a rather challenging enterprise is that the said structures are systematic on the one hand (e.g. in language-specific

¹ DIK (1997) refers to such phenomena as ‘extra-clausal constituents’; KALTENBÖCK – HEINE – KUTEVA (2011) prefer the term ‘theticals’.

characteristics of morphological makeup or positional regularities) but in some way interrupt, interfere with, or deviate from primary syntax on the other – mainly because they are not necessarily morphosyntactically and/or phonetically integrated into the syntagmatic context. In this sense, they run counter to expectations based on the language system.

In order to make such deviations meaningful, i.e. to distinguish them from errors, they have to be explicitly signalled as being intentionally deviating from what is to be expected. Thus, the recognition and assigning of their functions depends on individual habits, inter-individual conventions, and the (inter-)individual expectations they give rise to. The diverse ways of signalling indexical relations by secondary syntax – most prominently by intentional word order deviations as well as exceptional prosodic and morphological marking – are one of the most crucial aspects of secondary syntax investigated in the contributions to this issue of *Sprachwissenschaft*.

A syntax of pragmatics focuses on the processes of relating linguistically coded information to its situational context. In order to arrive at a comprehensive structural and functional account of the involved structures, issues related to prosodic and morphological (non-)marking, syntactic (non-)integration, word order related freedom and restrictedness need to be analysed with respect to their relationship to the encoding of pragmatic functions and their relevance for interpretation.

Within this general framework, the articles gathered here analyse language-specific structures, shed light on the cognitive effects related to the syntax of pragmatics, and discuss open questions in category formation. They illustrate both the challenges of dealing with structures which show interactions between syntax and pragmatics and the benefits of approaching them from a unifying point of view.

2. Addressing

Communicative understanding is based on the establishment of a relation between speaker and hearer – a relation which may be semantically encoded by particular morphosyntactic means, but which may also be signalled by using particular structures ‘in an addressing way’, i.e. by using them indexically. With respect to the encoding of addressing interlocutors, grammatical descriptions mainly focus on vocatives. Vocatives are usually integrated into traditional categories, e.g. subsumed as part of the nominal case paradigm (cf. for vocatives SONNENHAUSER – NOEL AZIZ HANNA 2013, HILL 2013,

QVONJE 1986). The wide variety of further signals marking addressing functions is peripheral in traditional grammar description, which may also be due to the inhomogeneity of their encoding by means of morphology, syntax and/or prosody.

The encoding of addresses by morphologically marked vocatives is illustrated in (1a) for Russian. Another option is to mark the same function by obligatory or optional particles, as in German (1b), and/or by prosody; in writing (1c), addresses can be marked by punctuation. Their specific function (such as call or reassurance) is linked to their syntactic position (2a-c) and may be restricted, in particular by their internal structure or by semantic and pragmatic constraints (e.g. ZWICKY 1974 on the external and internal syntax of vocatives, calls and addresses; D'AVIS – MEIBAUER 2013 on the relation between internal structure of addressees and their functions).

- (1) a. *Tanjuš*, čto slučilos' ? (Nom = *Tanjuša*) (www.ruscorpora.ru)
'Tanjuša, what happened?'
- b. *Hey Du!*
'Hey you!'
- c. *Tanja*, was ist passiert?
'Tanja, what happened?'
- (2) a. *Peter*, was hast du gesagt?
'Peter, what have you said?'
- b. Was, *Peter*, hast du gesagt?
'What, Peter, have you said?'
- c. Was hast du gesagt, *Peter*?
'What have you said, Peter?'

The various means of signalling serve the directing of attention. One of these devices indicates indexical information by signalling the non-referentiality of specific elements, i.e. as providing conceptual but not referential information. This has to be indicated explicitly. In addition, information is provided on how these elements should be interpreted. Both is achieved by the indexical relation between primary and secondary structures, inferred from the perception of a structure as being intentionally non-integrated.

3. Adding

The syntax of pragmatics also encompasses mechanisms of adding information, i.e. of providing additional or supplementary information to the proposition conveyed. Despite not being syntactically integrated into the primary structure, this supplementary information is relevant in various ways to the interpretation of the syntactic structure being processed. Parentheticals, quotations, and other extra-clausal structures show a wide variety of relations to primary syntactic structure and hence various ways of encoding indexicality. In this way, the structural configuration consisting of primary syntax plus secondary syntax which conveys supplementary information leads to a complex, i.e. a multi-component, structure.

Similar to vocatives, parentheticals and quotations do not fit into traditional linguistic categories. As one attempt to get around the problems of classification, parenthetical structures are dealt with as part of language usage and are disregarded as regular structures – or classified in terms of existing descriptive categories, i.e. as a part of speech of their own (for Russian parenthetical adverbs, see ISAČENKO 1995: 614-620) or as a special case of non-restrictive relative clause, adposition, discontinuity, and the like. Quotations are mainly treated in the context of orthographic regulations, because they become visible in punctuation. Syntactic analyses tend to focus on their relation to the embedding predicate, e.g. the question as to whether direct speech may be analysed as clausal direct object to the verb of speech (e.g. MUNRO 1982, AMBERBER 1996).

Again, it is the explicit signalisation of being non-integrated that makes these structures meaningful for the recipient. In contrast to the addressing structures mentioned above, their meaning consists in providing additional information (speaker attitudes, epistemic judgements, comments etc.). This becomes particularly evident if the structures in question would in principle fit perfectly into the basic structure, as in (3). Here, the signalisation of non-integration contributes an additional aspect of interpretation that would not be present otherwise (as LAMPRECHT 1992: 405 points out, this would yield a completely different text):

- (3) a. Antworten von fünf – *männlichen* – Fraktionschefs aus dem bayerischen Landtag.
(www.sueddeutsche.de, 2.2.2011)
'Answers by five – male – chairmen of a parliamentary group of the Bavarian state parliament'

- (3) b. každýj sygraet s každym na svoem i čužom pole (*belymi i černymi figurami*)
(<https://iz.ru/>, 9.3.18)
'everyone will play with everyone on his own and the other's field (*with white and black chessmen*)'

In other cases, the explicit signalisation of these structures may be necessary in order to prevent the overall structure from being ungrammatical and to make it meaningful, as in (4).

- (4) a. Das signalisierte schon die Attacke von Kroos gegen Khedira (*gelbe Karte*), die aber Rüdiger (*gelbe Karte*) umgehend gegen Shaqiri konterte.
(www.sueddeutsche.de, 29.1.2014)
'This has already been signalled by Kroos' attack against Khedira (yellow card), which has instantly been returned by Rüdiger (yellow card) against Shaqiri'
- (4) b. Sredi futbolistov »Reala« otičilis' Kristiano Ronaldo (gol na 52-j minute) i Kazemiro (na 80-j). Gol »Pari Sen-Žermen« prinadležit Edinsonu Kavani (71-ja minuta). (<https://iz.ru/>, 9.3.18)
'Excelling among the football players of 'Real' were Christiano Ronaldo (goal in minute 52) and Casemiro (minute 80). The goal for 'Paris St. Germain' is Edinson Cavani's (minute 71).'

The examples in (4) also illustrate that supplementary information constitutes a level of communication in its own right, that is connected to the 'basic' level: the two insertions in (4a) and (4b) not only relate to the surrounding propositions by commenting on them, but also interact with each other. This is particularly evident in (4b), where the second insertion *na 80-j* 'minute 80' is elliptical, omitting contextually retrievable information provided in the first insertion.

As with addressing structures, position is relevant for processing and interpretation. In German (5a-b), the position of parentheticals has an impact on the degree of epistemicity (cf. NOEL AZIZ HANNA – SONNENHAUSER 2013b; NOEL AZIZ HANNA 2015).

- (5) a. Er, *denke ich*, hat den Wagen am Freitag am Marienplatz
He think I has the car at-the Friday at-the Marienplatz
gesehen.
seen
- b. Er hat den Wagen, *denke ich*, am Freitag am Marienplatzgesehen.
He has the car think I at-the Friday at-the Marienplatz seen
'I think he has seen the car at Marienplatz on Friday'

For quotatives, too, the position of insertion matters for the interpretation of the overall structure. The quotation in (6a, b) is immediately adjacent to the verb of the matrix clause. While in many cases it may seem appropriate to

analyse quotations as complements to their matrix verbs, examples such as (6c) show that this is not necessarily the case. Rather, signalisation marks the structure under consideration as extra-clausal information provided from another communicative situation; at the same time, the secondary syntactic structure is integrated into the primary structure and related to the information conveyed.

- (6) a. Wenn sie sagt „Ich habe kein Selbstbewusstsein“ ...
(<http://www.pickupforum.de/topic/119060>)
‘When she says “I am not self-confident” ...’
- b. „Wissen Sie: ich habe mir nichts vorzuwerfen, ich habe mich nie verstellt“, antwortet Streit. (<http://www.express.de/fussball/der-streit-fall-er-sagt>)
“You know, I do not blame myself, I have never dissimulated”, answered Streit.
- c. Schuster kündigt „zeitnahe Entscheidung“ an (<http://www.kicker.at/>, 6.2.2014)
‘Schuster announces “prompt decision”’
- d. „Ich sage ausdrücklich: *Ich bin für Bürgerbeteiligung, ich bin für Transparenz, ...*“ (Merkel, Rede vom 15. November 2010 am CDU-Parteitag in Karlsruhe, [focus.de cdu-friedrichsdorf.de](http://focus.de/cdu-friedrichsdorf.de))
‘I say explicitly: “I am for public participation, I am for transparency, ...”’

Quotatives as imitations of another person’s voice can be marked by specific prosody or by the use of punctuation (6a, c). Delocutive particles such as Russian *deskat*’ (7a) mark the locution (here: *otdyxaet* ‘he is taking a rest’) to be associated to a character, instead of the narrator (cf. SONNENHAUSER 2010). In a similar vein, formulaic utterances like German *sie so, ich dann so* (‘she said ... I said ...’) serve as quotative signals (7b) and thus as an instantiation of indexical function.

- (7) a. Ja begu k Volode na vtoroj etaž, nevziraja na predostereženija madam Ker, čto on, *deskat*’, *otdyxaet*. (www.ruscorpora.ru, 1.2.2014)
‘I run to Volodja on the second floor, without respecting Madam Ker’s reminder that he *deskat*’ is taking a rest’
- b. *sie so ... ich dann so ...*
‘she said ... I said ...’

4. Signalling

How are the above structures and their functions signalled? It has already been pointed out that the occurrence, distribution, and type of signalling of the above-mentioned categories is non-trivial. Their signalisation guarantees their meaningfulness and hence their potential of receiving an interpretation. The signalisation is constrained by medium and genre and displays language-specific characteristics. Among the potential means of signalisation are, for

instance, particles indicating the structure, intonation contours restricted to the structure itself, morphosyntactic marking of the structure, and the position in which the syntactically non-integrated structure occurs. In (8), the signalisation of the (prosodically and syntactically non-integrated) vocative German NP (8b) has to be distinguishable from the (prosodically and syntactically integrated) referential NP (8a).

- (8) a. Hast du *Max* den Brief korrigiert?
 Have you Max.DAT the letter corrected
 ‘Did you correct the letter for Max?’
 b. Hast du, *Max*, den Brief korrigiert?
 Have you Max.VOC the letter corrected
 ‘Did you correct the letter, Max?’

Russian, in contrast, does not always display an ambiguity between referential and vocative NP because of optional morphological case marking by which vocative and referential uses of noun phrases may be distinguished. In (9a), the proper name *Dima* is morphologically marked as vocative *Dim*, whereas in (9b) its vocative usage has to be explicitly signalled, since the morphological make-up is identical to the nominative. (9b) also demonstrates the relevance of syntactic position – the double use of a vocative would be redundant without a functional difference based on syntactic position.

- (9) a. Dim, ob’’jasni, kak èto proizošlo? (ww.ruscorpora.ru, 9.3.18)
 ‘Dima, explain, how did this happen?’
 b. *Dima*, potorpis’, *Dima*! (www.superputin.ru/21.html, 26.12.2013)
 ‘*Dima*, hurry up, *Dima*!’

The linguistic signalling of secondary syntactic structures involved in addressing and adding information comprises five phases (cf. Figure 1). 1) The transition between ‘primary syntax’ and the signal introducing the non-integrated structure, 2) the transition from the signal to the non-integrated structure, 3) the inner structure, 4) the transition from the non-integrated structure to signal 2, and 5) the transition from signal 2 to the following domain of ‘primary syntax’.

The signal itself can be realised, for instance, by a pause, a hesitation, or by special intonation. In written texts, punctuation serves this end.

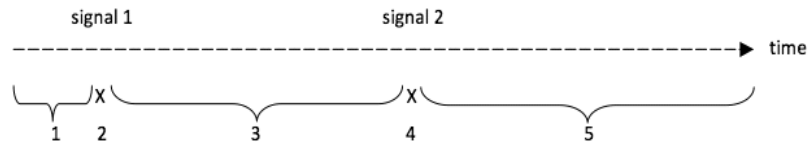


Figure 1

5. ‘Unexpected structures’ – the contributions to this issue

The contributions to this issue of *Sprachwissenschaft* deal with structures of language use which deviate from what is expected in terms of syntactic integration, prosodic integration, and/or morphological marking. The phenomena discussed display high variation concerning form (lexemes, syntagmas), signalisation (intonation, sequencing), and position (initial, medial, final). They share an indexical function by which a layer of secondary syntax is related with primary syntax.

The functions ascribed to the signalling of intentional deviations from the expected are investigated by analyses of their structural and functional commonalities as well as aspects of category formation. FORKER investigates syntactic and semantic parallels between quotatives and parentheticals. Based on her fieldwork data, she discusses the syntactic integration of reported speech constructions in Sanzhi Dargwa (Nakh-Daghestanian), their grammatical status, their extension to other domains of grammar, and the mixture of shifted and unshifted deictic elements. SLOCUM offers a proposal for the description of mid-sentential placement of English vocatives as well as a scalar grammaticality judgment survey, with theoretical implications for the syntax-pragmatics interface. The results show that vocatives are sensitive to syntactic islands and suggest that mid-sentential vocatives are derived by phrasal and remnant movement for information structure. GARCIA CASTILLERO provides new insight into the pragmatic function of extra-clausal NPs by investigating the key role of default word order and by clarifying the systematic relationship between extra-clausal and intra-clausal elements in Old Irish. His diachronic approach stands in contrast to stative categorisations of the phenomenon. NOEL AZIZ HANNA explores the phases involved in the signalling and functionalisation of the German vocative. She demonstrates the syntagmatic nature of this category by highlighting two main features: the vocative’s dependence on sentence mood and its effects on the sentence in which it is embedded.

In this issue, deviations of the expected are presented and analysed in terms of their potential for interpretation. In this respect, *The syntax of pragmatics: Addressing, adding, signalling* aims at a deeper understanding of syntax in general.

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